

Difficulty Breathing - Sympathetic Crashing Acute Pulmonary Edema (SCAPE) or Congestive Heart Failure (CHF)

History: • Timing? Worse when lying down? • With or without history of CHF • Medication often prescribed – Beta Blockers, Calcium Channel Blockers, Nitroglycerin, Lasix, Ace Inhibitors, Hydrochlorothiazide (HCTZ), Diuretics, Digoxin • Hypertension? • Cardiac disease? Previous MI? Asthma/COPD? PE risk factors?	Signs / Symptoms: • Respiratory distress • Bilateral rales (crackles) • Fever, cough • Apprehension, agitation, anxiety • Orthopnea • Pink, frothy sputum • Peripheral edema, diaphoresis • Hypertension (>180 systolic) • Chest Pain • Fatigue • Paroxysmal nocturnal dyspnea	Differential Diagnosis: • Anaphylaxis • Aspiration • Asthma • COPD • Pericarditis • Pneumonia • Pneumothorax • Pulmonary embolus • Myocardial infarction • Toxic inhalation
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EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline
- Sit upright or in optimal position to minimize respiratory distress

Paramedic

- Follow General Medical Care / Adult Resuscitation Guideline
- 12 – Lead EKG (if available)

Respiratory Distress

- Consider assisting respirations with BVM
- **NTG** 0.4mg SL every 4 minutes, maintain SBP >110 (No Limit to NTG)
 - ***Avoid NTG if Viagra, Revatio, Levitra or Cialis recently used last 48 hrs***